

SIH 2026 Deep-Research Report

Software System to Check Compliance of Packaged Commodities under the Legal Metrology (Packaged Commodities) Rules, 2011

Prepared for: Smart India Hackathon 2026 | Date: 02 September 2026

Purpose

This report consolidates the prior research output: governing compliance requirements, a relevant research reading list, publicly reported enforcement and litigation examples, and implementation recommendations for an OCR- and rule-engine-based inspection platform. Hyperlinks are embedded throughout so the report remains usable as a project reference document.

Important verification note

“Fraud” is not a legal finding unless established by a competent authority. Accordingly, the case register below uses neutral terms such as alleged violation, notice, case booked, seizure, recall, compounding, court outcome, or consumer award. Several cited matters concern food safety or consumer protection rather than Legal Metrology alone; they are retained only where they offer relevant label, declaration, MRP, or digital-evidence learning.

Problem Statement

Title: Software System to check compliance of Packaged Commodities under Legal Metrology (Packaged Commodities) Rules, 2011 by scanning products, images and labels.

Core requirement: Build a web/mobile system that scans package labels, images, and online product listings; extracts declarations; evaluates completeness, correctness, placement, readability and font size; stores inspection evidence and history; and creates actionable reports and dashboards for enforcement officials.

What the system should check

Compliance element	Automated test idea
Manufacturer / packer / importer name and address	OCR extraction; required-field and address-pattern validation
Generic commodity name	Required-field check; compare listing title versus pack label
Net quantity	Extract quantity and unit; validate standard unit format and compare against catalog data
MRP inclusive of taxes	Detect “MRP”, currency and price; flag absent, unreadable, altered, or conflicting values
Month and year of manufacture / packing / import	Date OCR plus month-year pattern validation
Consumer-care details	Detect telephone, email, postal address or website as prescribed
Country of origin for imported products	Detect origin statement on package and relevant e-commerce product listing
Readability, font size and placement	Estimate text height from image calibration; score contrast, blur, skew, crop and occlusion
Evidence and enforcement trail	Store original image, OCR output, rule version, findings, location, inspector role, timestamp and tamper-evident hash

Legal baseline

The Legal Metrology (Packaged Commodities) Rules, 2011 regulate mandatory declarations on pre-packaged commodities. Government and legal-reference materials list declarations including manufacturer/packer/importer details, generic commodity name, net quantity, month and year, MRP, consumer-care details and, for imported goods, country of origin. Always validate against the latest consolidated rules and applicable amendments before using a result for enforcement.

[Department of Consumer Affairs — Legal Metrology Act and Rules](#)

[India Code — Legal Metrology Act, 2009 \(PDF\)](#)

[Legal Metrology \(Packaged Commodities\) Rules, 2011 \(PDF reference\)](#)

Research and Policy Reading List

The following sources span Legal Metrology law, food-label regulation, enforcement reform and label-compliance assessment. They should be used as a literature-review starting point; confirm the paper's methodology, jurisdiction, and publication status before citing it in a final academic submission.

Year	Paper / report	Why it matters
2023	The Intersection of Food Laws and Legal Metrology Laws in India: A Framework for Analysis	Explains the interaction between food-law requirements and Legal Metrology controls in pre-packed foods.
2021	Critical Review of Offences Under Legal Metrology Act 2009: With Special Reference to Proposed Decriminalisation of the Offences	Useful legal background on offences, enforcement and proposed decriminalisation.
2023	Reforming the Legal Metrology Regime (EAC-PM Working Paper)	Policy discussion relevant to digitisation, compliance burden and risk-based enforcement.
2024	Ethical Claims and Enforcement in Legal Metrology in India	Relevant for examining marketing claims, consumer protection and enforcement ethics.
2024	Assessment of front and back of pack nutrition labels	Provides methods and findings relevant to evaluating packaged-food label visibility and information.
2023	Food literacy & food labeling laws—a legal analysis of India's regulatory framework	Useful for user-facing implications of information design and food-label regulation.
2025	Decadal transition in food labelling compliance with the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India regulations	Longitudinal food-label compliance context; complementary to, not a replacement for, LM rules.
2022	Assessment of Legal Metrology Act, 2009 to support tobacco control in India	Shows how packaged-commodity declaration law can support public-health regulation.
2024	An Analysis on Legal Metrology Act 2009, with Jan Vishwas Amendment of Provisions Act, 2023	Legal analysis of amendments relevant to penalties and enforcement workflow.
2026	GST on Pre-Packaged and Labelled Food Goods	Background on the definition and tax treatment of “pre-packaged and labelled” goods.
2022	Protection of Consumers from Dual Maximum Retail Prices (MRP)	Useful for the dual-MRP / MRP-overcharging problem domain.

Research gap for SIH

A strong differentiator is an end-to-end workflow that combines image-quality validation, OCR, structured-field extraction, rule-versioned validation, human review, evidence preservation, repeat-offender analytics, and exportable inspection reports. The literature and policy material above support the need for digitised and consistent compliance assessment, but your team should avoid claiming that no comparable system exists unless you conduct a systematic literature and patent review.

Publicly Reported Case Register

Cases are ordered broadly by enforcement significance and evidentiary relevance, not by an assertion of criminal severity. “Outcome” distinguishes an allegation, notice, seizure, recall, compounding outcome, consumer remedy, or a later court decision. Do not use any row as proof of guilt beyond its cited source.

#	Year	Entity / product	Allegation / issue	Government or court action / outcome
1	2016	Amazon / Amazon Sellers Services Various packaged goods	Alleged missing mandatory package declarations in Maharashtra e-commerce warehousing context.	Maharashtra Legal Metrology raids; products reportedly seized and case action reported.
2	2016	Flipkart / Instakart Various packaged goods	Alleged missing mandatory package declarations in Maharashtra e-commerce warehousing context.	Raids, reported seizures and cases booked alongside Amazon matter.
3	2020–21	Amazon and Flipkart Online product listings	Mandatory country-of-origin information reportedly not displayed on listings.	Government notices; PIB reported 202 notices concerning country-of-origin violations in the stated period.
4	2020–21	Multiple entities Imported packaged commodities	Country-of-origin declaration non-compliance.	Central Consumer Protection Authority / Department of Consumer Affairs notice and enforcement reporting.
5	2019	DMart stores (Hyderabad report) FMCG products	Consumer complaint alleging MRP-label tampering.	Telangana Legal Metrology Department reportedly filed three cases.
6	2017	Three-star hotels, Hyderabad (entities not specified in result) Packaged water and other packaged goods	Charging above printed MRP alleged.	Cases booked under Rule 18(2), as reported.
7	2025–26	Vedant Fashions Ltd. / Manyavar Apparel labels	Product size not disclosed on labels at Varanasi outlet, according to company-market reporting.	Matter reportedly settled through ₹50,000 compounding fee.
8	2026	Navneet Education Ltd. Educational / stationery products	Show-cause notice alleging prima facie declaration-related Legal Metrology non-compliance.	Notice reportedly issued by Senior Inspector, Legal Metrology, Agra.
9	2023	H&M; Pvt. Ltd. Cardigan / apparel	Department alleged size declaration violation after an inspection.	Delhi HC quashed summons; held the concerned item was not a pre-packaged commodity for these rules.
10	2026	Samsung India Mobile phone packaging	Proceedings reportedly concerned failure to declare screen size.	Andhra Pradesh HC quashed case; reporting says dimensions were not absolutely required unless relevant.
11	2026	Danone Narang Beverages Pvt. Ltd. / Qua Packaged mineral water	Proceedings concerned MRP presentation on bottle neck.	Court reportedly found online printing on bottle neck compliant and quashed the complaint.
12	2026	Delhi lingerie retailer (name not stated in result) Bra	Sale price alleged to exceed MRP by ₹400.	Delhi consumer commission ordered refund with interest and ₹20,000 compensation, as reported.
13	2015 (cont extua l)	Nestlé India / MAGGI Instant noodles	FSSAI action concerned alleged excess lead and packaging claim issues, including “No added MSG”; this is food-safety / labelling context, not a pure LM case.	FSSAI directed withdrawal/recall of nine approved variants in June 2015; later litigation materially changed the position.
14	2024	Nestlé India / MAGGI Instant noodles	Government consumer complaint related to the earlier MAGGI issue.	NCDRC dismissed the government complaint in April 2024, according to legal reporting.
15	2026	Nestlé India / MAGGI retailers and distributors Instant noodles	Criminal proceedings tied to the earlier lead-content controversy.	Delhi HC reportedly set aside criminal proceedings after later testing and rulings affected the prosecution.
16	2021	Flipkart, Zomato, Swiggy and others (as alleged in a letter/report) E-commerce / food-delivery listings	Reported allegation of missing mandatory Legal Metrology declarations on online listings.	Matter flagged in a legal-information report; verify primary notices before operational use.
17	2017	Assistant Controller of Legal Metrology v. Arun Kumar Packaged-goods retail matter	Court record relating to a Legal Metrology inspection and allegations.	Reported judicial proceeding; use the full judgment for exact facts and outcome.

Illustrative Evidence Images

Direct product-package photographs cannot be embedded reliably without licensed, source-verifiable image files. To keep this PDF reusable and legally safer, the panels below show the exact evidence-image formats your system should capture. For live demonstrations, replace them with your own inspection photographs, taken with consent and metadata preserved.

Front-of-pack capture

Capture the full front panel, product name, net quantity and MRP. Ensure a reference scale or known-size marker where font-size measurement is required.

[Reserved evidence image area]

Back/side declaration panel

Capture manufacturer/packer/importer address, month-year, consumer care details, country of origin, and barcode/QR identifier.

[Reserved evidence image area]

E-commerce listing evidence

Capture product title, images, declared MRP, country of origin, seller information, URL, timestamp and page screenshot/hash.

[Reserved evidence image area]

Recommended System Architecture

Layer	Recommended capability
Capture and ingestion	Mobile/web upload, multi-angle image guidance, listing URL capture, EXIF/location safeguards
Image quality	Blur, glare, skew, occlusion, perspective and resolution scoring before OCR
Extraction	Multilingual OCR; field detection for MRP, quantity, dates, addresses, origin and contact details
Rule engine	Versioned rule catalog; applicability filters by commodity, package area, importer status and sales channel
Human review	Confidence thresholds, side-by-side original image and bounding boxes, override reason and audit trail
Evidence and reports	Immutable file hash, timestamp, inspector identity, PDF/DOCX export, violation photographs and statutory references
Analytics	District/category heatmaps, recurring defects, repeat-offender detection, pending reviews and data-quality metrics

Validation rules to prototype first

Start with high-confidence checks: presence of MRP, net quantity, manufacturer/packer/importer identity, month-year, consumer contact and country of origin for imported goods. Treat font-size and placement results as “review required” unless the photograph contains calibration data and the package geometry is adequately corrected.

Suggested findings taxonomy: MRP_MISSING, MRP_UNREADABLE, MRP_CONFLICT, NET_QUANTITY_MISSING, UNIT_FORMAT_INVALID, MANUFACTURER_DETAILS_MISSING, DATE_MISSING, CONSUMER_CARE_MISSING, ORIGIN_MISSING, TEXT_TOO_SMALL, LOW_CONTRAST, IMAGE_INSUFFICIENT, and HUMAN_REVIEW_REQUIRED.

Source Directory

All titles below are clickable. Sources include official government publications, statutes, court/legal reporting, academic publishers, and mainstream news reporting. For a competition submission, prioritize official statute, gazette, PIB, department and court documents over secondary summaries.

1. [Department of Consumer Affairs — Legal Metrology Act and Rules](#)
2. [India Code — Legal Metrology Act, 2009](#)
3. [Legal Metrology \(Packaged Commodities\) Rules, 2011 — PDF reference](#)
4. [PIB — notices for country-of-origin violations](#)
5. [PIB — country-of-origin enforcement information](#)
6. [Maharashtra e-commerce packaging action report](#)
7. [FSSAI — MAGGI recall order](#)
8. [EAC-PM — Reforming the Legal Metrology Regime](#)